

Personas, Jobs-to-be-Done & the RBAC Role Model

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Reconciled (§11.4.35, 2026-06-26): the RBAC role set is fixed to the authoritative `svc-identity.md` enum `{member, operator, admin}` (+ **Device**, which holds **no RBAC** and is policy-gated). The earlier invented "**tenant owner**" RBAC role is **removed** — `admin` is the top RBAC role — and the missing **operator** role (mint enroll tokens / manage devices + policies + advertise prefixes) is **added**. "Self-hoster / tenant-owner" is modelled as a **host/deployment privilege**, NOT an RBAC role. The connector-operator's `route.advertised` capability is **operator-tier**, not `member`. This aligns the document to `use-cases-and-journeys.md` UC-04 (`admin/operator`) and the `svc-identity.md` §7.3 `minRole` table, which win on any conflict.

Document role. Volume 1 deep document that expands §5 (personas and the three app classes) and §3 (the three system roles) of the overview ~~00-product-scope-and-principles.md~~ into a full persona catalogue (jobs-to-be-done, journeys, pain points, success criteria) **and** the RBAC role/capability model. It distinguishes two orthogonal axes that the overview keeps separate and that downstream readers routinely conflate:

1. **System roles** — *Connector / Gateway / Client* — the topological role a node plays in the data path [00 §3], [SPEC §3].
2. **Identity/RBAC roles** — *admin / operator / member / device (anon-device-token)* — the authorization a principal holds in the control plane [00 §12 "Tenant"], (security overview S1–S5), per `svc-identity.md`.

A persona is a *human*; an app class is the *software* a persona drives; a system role is the *topological position*; an RBAC role is the *permission grant*. This document maps all four.

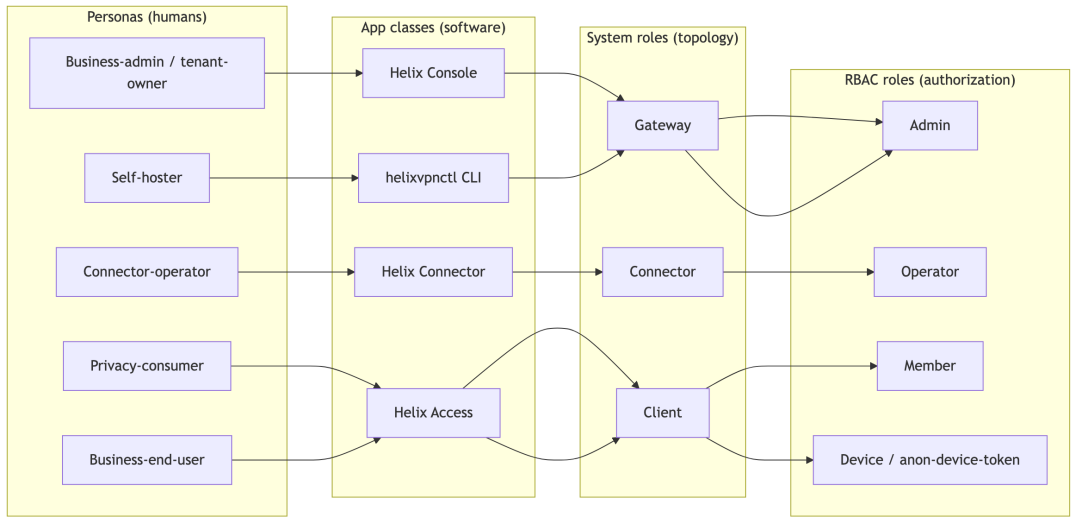
Status: SPEC-ONLY. The RBAC capability matrix here is the *product-level* view; the authoritative API-level permission contract is [../v03-control-plane/svc-identity.md](#) and the enforcement points are [../04-security-privacy-pki.md](#) (S1/S3). Where this document and svc-identity disagree on a capability, svc-identity wins (§11.4.35). Any capability not yet fixed by svc-identity is marked UNVERIFIED.

Evidence base. [00 §N] = the overview; [SPEC §N] = the spine; [SEC S#] = the security overview invariants [../04-security-privacy-pki.md](#).

Table of contents

- [1. The four-axis model](#)
 - [2. Persona catalogue](#)
 - [2.1 Privacy-consumer](#)
 - [2.2 Business-admin / tenant-owner](#)
 - [2.3 Business-end-user](#)
 - [2.4 Connector-operator](#)
 - [2.5 Self-hoster](#)
 - [3. Persona → app-class → system-role → RBAC-role mapping](#)
 - [4. The RBAC role model](#)
 - [5. Persona × capability matrix](#)
 - [6. Cross-persona journeys](#)
 - [7. Cross-document contracts this document fixes](#)
 - [Sources verified](#)
-

1. The four-axis model



The mapping is *not* one-to-one: a self-hoster holds the admin RBAC role *and* the host/deployment-owner privilege *and* operates Connectors *and* uses an Access client — one human, several roles. ("Tenant-ownership / self-hosting" is a host/deployment privilege, not an RBAC role — see §4.) The matrix in §5 makes every cell explicit so no capability is assumed.

Axis	Closed set	Source of truth
Persona	privacy-consumer, business-admin/tenant-owner, business-end-user, connector-operator, self-hoster	this doc §2
App class	Helix Access, Helix Console, Helix Connector, helixvpctl	[00 §5], [SPEC §3]
System role	Client, Gateway, Connector	[00 §3], [SPEC §3]
RBAC role	admin, operator, member, device (anon-device-token)	[00 §12], [SEC S1–S5], svc-identity (authoritative enum)

2. Persona catalogue

Each persona is given: **JTBD** (jobs-to-be-done), **primary journey**, **pain points it removes**, and **success criteria** (tied where possible to the 8-criteria MVP Definition-of-Done [00 §10.2], [SPEC §8.1]). Success criteria that are not yet a fixed acceptance gate are marked UNVERIFIED.

2.1 Privacy-consumer

"I want into a privacy exit (or my own lab) with one button, no email, and no way for anyone to log what I do." — the Mullvad use case [00 §5.1].

Field	Detail
Drives	Helix Access app (iOS, Android, desktop; Web limited)
System role	Client [00 §3.3]
RBAC role	Device, via anonymous device token (no email) [00 §9 F15]
JTBD	(1) connect to a privacy exit with one tap; (2) get automatic obfuscation that just works when a network blocks WG; (3) never leak when the tunnel drops; (4) hold an anonymous identity with no PII
Primary journey	install → anonymous device-token enrollment (key generated on-device, private key never leaves) → one-button connect → auto-ladder escalates plain → LWO → MASQUE if blocked → kill-switch + DNS-leak protection active throughout [00 §9 F7/F11/F13/F15], [SEC S2/S9]
Pain points removed	account email requirement (anonymous token); manual obfuscation fiddling (auto-ladder); leak-on-drop (core-owned kill-switch); trust-the-vendor no-logs (no-logging-as-code)
Success criteria	DoD#4 (auto-escalate to MASQUE when WG blocked); DoD#7 (kill-switch + DNS-leak verified, no leak on drop); anonymous enrollment succeeds with no PII captured
Sensitivities	memory- and battery-sensitive on mobile [00 §5.1]; the iOS NE ~15 MB ceiling is a hard constraint (G3)

2.2 Business-admin / tenant-owner

"I manage tenants, users, devices and policy for an organization (or several client orgs), and I need a live topology view and an audit trail of control actions." [00 §5.3]

Field	Detail
Drives	Helix Console (Web responsive + Desktop — same Flutter build, no tunnel core) [00 §5, §5.2]
System role	none in the data path — Console is API-client-only, drives the Gateway control plane [00 §5]
RBAC role	Admin (the top RBAC role; tenant-ownership is a host/deployment privilege, not an RBAC role)

Field	Detail
JTBD	(1) CRUD tenants/users/devices/networks/routes/policies; (2) see/revoke devices instantly; (3) author default-deny ACLs that compile to reachability; (4) read a control-action audit trail; (5) optionally manage multi-tenant billing
Primary journey	log in (OIDC) → create a tenant → invite members → approve/enroll devices → author policy (group:contractors → net:warehouse:554/tcp) → watch it converge in <1 s → revoke a lost device and watch enforcement in <1 s → review audit_events [00 §9 F17], [SPEC §8.1 DoD#5/#6], [SEC S5/S7]
Pain points removed	policy edits requiring restarts (push-based, <1 s); device revoke lag (<1 s edge enforcement); destinations/flows leaking into audit (audit is control-only)
Success criteria	DoD#5 (policy edit reflected <1 s, no restart); DoD#6 (device revoke enforced <1 s); audit records who-did-what-to-identity/policy/devices, never destinations [SEC S7]
Sensitivities	tenant isolation must be airtight — Postgres RLS, not app-layer only [SEC S6/RLS]

2.3 Business-end-user

"My admin set me up; I just want into the work networks I'm allowed to reach, and to be cleanly denied the ones I'm not." (derived from the ZTNA half of the dual model [00 §3, §4.2])

Field	Detail
Drives	Helix Access app
System role	Client
RBAC role	Member (an identity that belongs to a tenant, holds enrolled devices, but cannot administer the tenant)
JTBD	(1) connect and reach exactly the subset of joined networks policy grants; (2) be transparently denied unauthorized networks (default-deny, not an error to debug); (3) see only the peers/routes need-to-know permits
Primary journey	receive an enrollment invite/token from the admin → device generates its WG keypair (private key never leaves) → enroll → receive a policy-filtered network map (only granted peers/routes) → reach authorized

Field	Detail
	LAN host, denied unauthorized one [00 §4.2, §9 F17], [SEC S1/S3]
Pain points removed	over-broad access (need-to-know map — the user never even learns of peers it cannot reach [SEC S3]); confusing all-or-nothing VPNs (policy-scoped 1→N)
Success criteria	DoD#3 (reach an authorized LAN host AND deny an unauthorized one — default-deny proven); the user's map contains only granted peers [SEC S3]
Sensitivities	must not be able to enumerate the tenant topology beyond its grants (need-to-know is server-side, pre-wire)

2.4 Connector-operator

"Install one agent inside my LAN, it dials out, done — I never touch my router." [00 §5.2]

Field	Detail
Drives	Helix Connector (headless daemon on Linux/Windows/macOS + optional slim UI; Android/embedded for appliances) [00 §3.1, §5]
System role	Connector [00 §3.1]
RBAC role	Operator — the connector identity mints/redeems enroll tokens, manages devices + policies, and advertises prefixes; the <code>route.advertised</code> capability is operator-tier per svc-identity.md , not <code>member</code> . A self-hoster operating their own connector also holds admin (§2.5)
JTBD	(1) onboard a network without opening any inbound port; (2) advertise the CIDRs the network exposes (<code>route.advertised</code>); (3) set local ACLs; (4) run headless and reconnect resiliently
Primary journey	install agent on a LAN host → enroll (device cert + enrollment token) → dial outbound to the Gateway (reverse tunnel) → advertise CIDRs → Gateway routes authorized client traffic into the LAN and responses back out — neither side ever opened an inbound port [00 §3.1, §4.1, §8 P3]
Pain points removed	router port-forwarding (outbound-only); inbound attack surface (none); per-network bespoke VPN configs (same Rust core in advertise/route mode)

Field	Detail
Success criteria	DoD#2 (enroll a Connector); DoD#3 (an authorized client reaches a LAN host behind the advertised CIDR); the Connector establishes the tunnel with zero inbound exposure
Sensitivities	overlapping RFC1918 ranges across connectors must not collide (D4 → 4via6) [00 §4.2 #1]

2.5 Self-hoster

"I run the whole thing myself — Gateway, Connector(s), and my own Access client — because no-logs is credible only when I own the box." [00 §7.1]

Field	Detail
Drives	helixvpctl (Cobra CLI) for bring-up + Console + Connector + Access — wears all software hats
System role	operates Gateway, one or more Connectors, and a Client Admin of their own tenant(s) — the top RBAC role.
RBAC role	Tenant-ownership / self-hosting is a host/deployment privilege , NOT an RBAC role: the human who owns the box bootstraps each tenant (helixvpctl init) and then administers it as admin. A self-hoster running networks for multiple clients administers multiple tenants [00 §12]
JTBD	(1) stand up a Gateway from zero on a clean VPS with one command; (2) own the no-logs guarantee by owning the deployment; (3) scale the same images from one homelab pod to an HA fleet without a rewrite
Primary journey	helixvpctl init on a clean VPS (one rootless Podman pod: edge + control + Postgres + Redis) → enroll a Connector and a Client → reach a LAN host → confirm no durable connection log exists (schema-lint + runtime check) [00 §7.1, §10.2 DoD#1/#8], [SPEC §8.1]
Pain points removed	SaaS coordination dependency (self-hosted); vendor-trusted no-logs (self-evident ownership + CI-enforced schema); separate codebases for homelab vs fleet (same images, P6)
Success criteria	DoD#1 (self-host from zero via helixvpctl init); DoD#8 (no durable connection log AND all three apps drive the system); the same images scale to HA (Phase 2)
Sensitivities	

Field	Detail
	the CA root key + Postgres are the only secrets to protect — data-plane nodes are cattle [SEC S11]

3. Persona → app-class → system-role → RBAC-role mapping

Persona	Primary app class	Other apps used	System role(s)	RBAC role(s)	Uses tunnel core?
Privacy-consumer	Helix Access	—	Client	Device (anon-device-token)	yes (helix-core capture mode)
Business-admin / tenant-owner	Helix Console	(Access as a user)	none in data path	Admin	no (Console is API-client only)
Business-end-user	Helix Access	—	Client	Member (+ Device per enrolled device)	yes
Connector-operator	Helix Connector	(Console to verify routes)	Connector	Operator (+ Device); or Admin if self-hosting	yes (helix-core advertise/route mode)
Self-hoster	helixvpncctl + Console + Connector + Access	all	Gateway + Connector + Client	Admin (+ host/deployment-owner privilege)	yes (as Connector/Client)

Note (the single-tree flavoring contract, [00 §5.2]). All three apps build from one Flutter tree via `runHelixApp(flavor, home, capabilities), flavor ∈ {Access, Connector, Console}`; **Console is the only build that omits `core_ffi`** (no Rust tunnel core). The "Uses tunnel core?" column above is a direct consequence of this contract. Owned by [../03-client-core-and-ui.md](#).

4. The RBAC role model

The control plane authorizes principals by **RBAC role within a tenant**. A **tenant** is an isolated organization boundary enforced by Postgres RLS [00 §12], [SEC S6/RLS]. The closed role set is the authoritative `svc-identity.md` enum {member, operator, admin} (+ Device, which holds **no RBAC** and is policy-gated). **Tenant-ownership / self-hosting is a host/deployment privilege, not a member of this RBAC enum**. The role lattice (admin > operator > member, per `svc-identity.md` §7.3):

Admin

+ device revoke + user
management

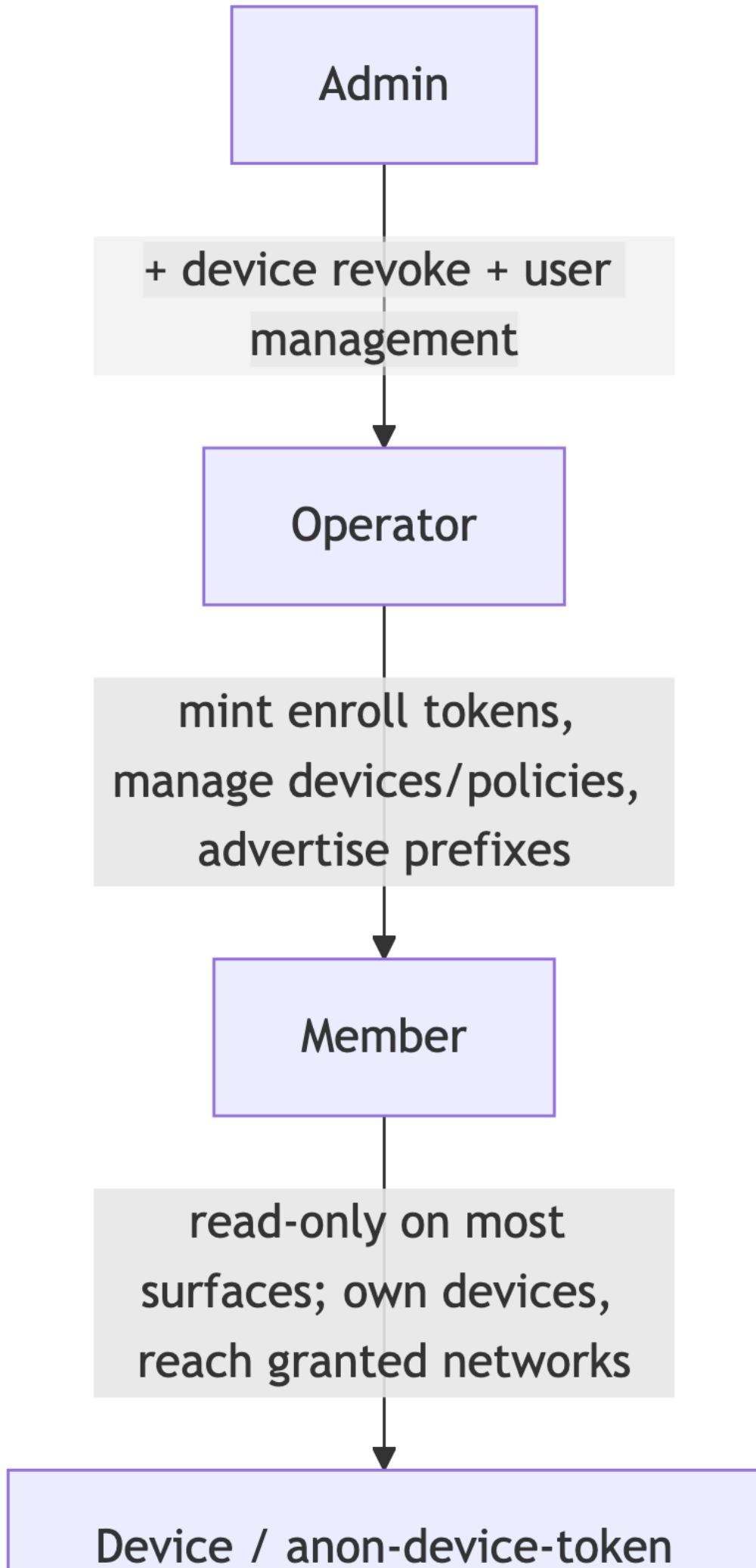
Operator

mint enroll tokens,
manage devices/policies,
advertise prefixes

Member

read-only on most
surfaces; own devices,
reach granted networks

Device / anon-device-token



4.1 Role definitions

RBAC role	Definition	Distinguishing capability	Authenticated by
Admin	The top RBAC role within a tenant — everything an Operator can do, plus device revoke and user management; the business-admin's and self-hoster's role	device revoke; user management; full CRUD on users/devices/networks/routes/policies	OIDC identity [00 §9 F15]
Operator	Manages a tenant's devices and policies and mints enrollment tokens; the connector-operator's role	mint/redeem enroll tokens; manage devices/policies; advertise prefixes (route.advertised)	OIDC identity
Member	A user that belongs to a tenant and owns enrolled devices; read-only on most administrative surfaces	enroll own devices; connect; reach granted networks	OIDC identity
Device / anon-device-token	<i>A data-plane principal</i> — an enrolled device holding its own WG keypair; holds no RBAC role (policy-gated, never the RBAC matrix) ; the anonymous-device-token variant has no human identity behind it (the privacy-consumer case)	open WatchNetworkMap; reach AllowedIPs; nothing administrative	short-lived mTLS device cert (≤24 h, tenant-CA-signed) [SEC S4], + WG Noise IK for data [SEC §1.2]

Host/deployment privilege (not RBAC). Tenant lifecycle (create/delete a tenant), bringing up the Gateway (`helixvpncctl init`), and any managed-SKU billing are **host/deployment-owner** capabilities the self-hoster exercises by owning the box — they are **not** entries in the `{member, operator, admin}` RBAC enum. `svc-identity.md` §7.3's `minRole` table (the authoritative `Permission` → `Role` map) tops out at `admin` (user management + device revoke); it has no "tenant owner" tier.

4.2 Two authentication channels, never conflated

Per the security overview [SEC §1.2], a principal authenticates on two *independent* channels:

1. **Control channel** (`Coordinator.WatchNetworkMap/.Enroll/...`): short-lived device cert (mTLS, ≤24 h, auto-renew), tenant-CA-signed [SEC S4].
2. **Data channel** (the tunnel): WireGuard Noise IK; peer pubkeys delivered via the policy-filtered map [SEC §1.2].

Compromising one does not yield the other. A device must be valid on **both** to *learn* its peers and *reach* them. This is why the **Device** RBAC role is the join point between identity (control) and reachability (data).

4.3 Default-deny is the RBAC ground state (S1)

A Member's device with no policy grant has an **empty AllowedIPs and no edge verdict entry** — cryptographically and administratively isolated even though enrolled and online [SEC S1, §1.3]. RBAC roles grant *administrative* capability; *reachability* is a separate, additive, default-empty grant compiled by the policy service. Holding the Member role does **not** imply reaching any network.

4.4 Anonymous device tokens (the privacy lane)

The anonymous-device-token enrollment is a first-class path alongside OIDC [00 §9 F15]: a device enrolls and obtains a control identity with **no email / no PII**, generating its WG keypair on-device (private key never leaves) [SEC S2]. This is the privacy-consumer's principal — a Device (holding no RBAC role) with no human member/operator/admin behind it. Owned by [../v05-security/identity-and-enrollment.md](#)

- [../v03-control-plane/svc-identity.md](#).

UNVERIFIED — the precise capability ceiling of an anonymous-device-token principal (e.g. whether it may advertise prefixes, or only consume a privacy-exit) is fixed by `svc-identity`, not here. Until `svc-`

identity pins it, this document assumes anon tokens are **privacy-exit/consume-only** (the consumer case), which is the conservative default per §11.4.6.

5. Persona × capability matrix

Capabilities are grouped by control-plane domain. Legend:  allowed ·  denied ·  allowed only on own resources ·  policy-gated (granted additively, default-deny §4.3). The authoritative permission contract is svc-identity; rows it has not yet fixed are UNVERIFIED (flagged inline).

Capability	Privacy-consumer (Device/ anon)	Business-end-user (Member)	Connector-operator (Operator)	Business-admin (Admin)	Self-host (Admin) host privilege
Connect / open tunnel			 (advertise/route mode)	n/a (Console)	
Use Gateway as privacy exit			n/a	n/a	
Reach a joined private network	 (anon = exit-only, UNVERIFIED)		 (its own LAN)	n/a	
Advertise CIDRs (route.advertised)			 (for its connector)	 (set on behalf)	
Enroll a device	 (self only)	 (own devices)	 (own connector)	 (any in tenant)	
See own devices				 (all)	
Revoke a device	 (own)	 (own)	 (own connector)	 (any, <1 s)	
Author / edit ACL policy			 (Operator tier = PermManagePolicy; local-vs-central scope UNVERIFIED)		
CRUD users					
CRUD networks / routes			 (its own routes)		
Read control-action audit					
Manage tenants (create/delete)				 (host/ deployment privilege, not	 (host/ deployment

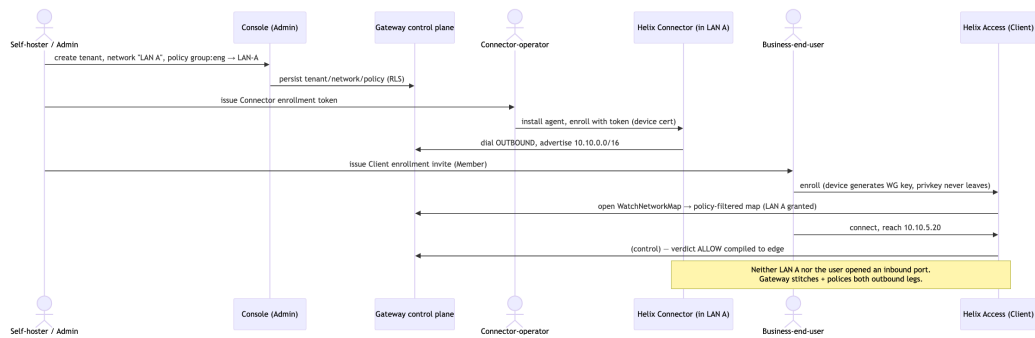
Capability	Privacy-consumer (Device/ anon)	Business-end-user (Member)	Connector-operator (Operator)	Business-admin (Admin)	Self-host (Admin) host privile
				RBAC; UNVERIFIED whether ever exposed to admin)	privile RBAC)
Manage billing (optional SKU)	🚫	🚫	🚫	🚫 (host/ deployment / managed-SKU privilege; UNVERIFIED)	✅ (ho deploy manag SKU privile
Bring up Gateway (helixvpncctl init)	🚫	🚫	🚫	🚫	✅ (ho deploy privile RBAC)

Honesty note (§11.4.6). The matrix is the *product-intent* view. Three cells are UNVERIFIED because the exact grant is fixed by svc-identity/svc-policy, not by a product narrative: (a) whether an anon device token may reach a private network or is exit-only; (b) the local-vs-central scope of a Connector-operator's (Operator-tier) policy authoring; (c) whether tenant-lifecycle and billing — both **host/deployment privileges, not RBAC** — are ever surfaced through the admin role or remain box-owner-exclusive. Each is a tracked refinement item; the conservative default (narrower grant) is assumed until pinned, per §11.4.6/§11.4.101.

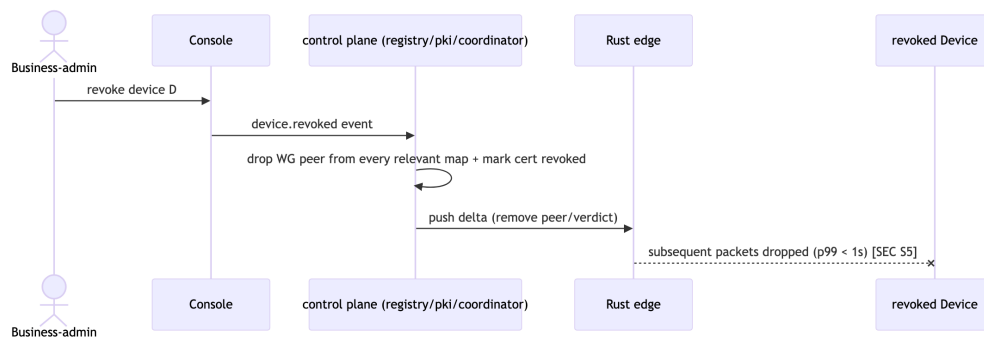
6. Cross-persona journeys

6.1 Onboarding a network so a remote user can reach it (the founding journey)

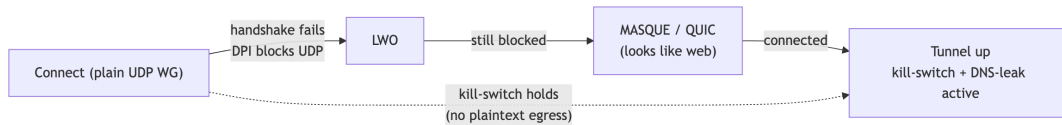
This is the canonical multi-persona flow that realizes the founding constraint [00 §2.1, §4.1] — three personas, no inbound port-forward:



6.2 Lost-device revocation (admin + device, <1 s)



6.3 Privacy-consumer auto-obfuscation under DPI (one persona, one journey)



The escalation ladder is driven by handshake-failure events; throughout, the kill-switch holds so no plaintext egress occurs while escalating [00 §9 F7/F11], [SEC S9].

7. Cross-document contracts this document fixes

1. **Four-axis separation** (§1) — persona ≠ app class ≠ system role ≠ RBAC role; every later document **MUST** keep these distinct (the overview conflates persona and app class loosely in §5; this document is the disambiguation authority for Volume 1).
2. **Persona → RBAC mapping** (§3, §5) — consumed by functional-requirements.md (each FR names the persona/role it serves) and bound to the authoritative ../v03-control-plane/svc-identity.md.

3. **Device is the join point** of control identity and data reachability (§4.2) — inherited from [SEC §1.2], not redefined.
 4. **Default-deny is the RBAC ground state** (§4.3) — RBAC grants administrative capability; reachability is a separate additive default-empty grant ([SEC S1], ../v03-control-plane/svc-policy.md).
 5. **Anonymous device tokens are first-class** (§4.4) — the privacy lane; owned by svc-identity + identity-and-enrollment.md.
 6. **The single-tree flavoring contract** (§3 note) governs "which persona's app carries the tunnel core" — inherited from [00 §5.2].
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Sources verified

- 00-product-scope-and-principles.md §3 (three roles), §4 (two-way + multi-network), §5 + §5.1/§5.2 (personas, app classes, flavoring contract), §9 (parity matrix — F15 anon account, F17 device mgmt), §10.2 (8-criteria DoD), §12 (glossary — tenant).
- SPECIFICATION.md §3 (roles + app classes), §8.1 (MVP DoD), §9 (D2 client core).
- 04-security-privacy-pki.md §0.1 (S1–S11 invariants), §1.1 (trust gradient), §1.2 (two auth channels), §1.3 (default-deny realization) — authoritative for the RBAC enforcement model.
- MASTER_INDEX.md Volume 1 row (declared scope: "Each persona: jobs-to-be-done, journeys, pain points, success") + Volume 3 row (svc-identity as the authoritative permission contract).
- Cross-refs forward: svc-identity.md, svc-policy.md, identity-and-enrollment.md, 03-client-core-and-ui.md.

Honesty note (§11.4.6): the persona success criteria are tied to the 8-criteria MVP DoD where one exists; the RBAC capability matrix is the product-intent view, with every cell whose grant is not yet fixed by svc-identity/svc-policy marked UNVERIFIED and defaulted to the narrower grant. No permission was asserted as final that the authoritative control-plane docs have not yet pinned.

Constitution bindings: §11.4.44 (revision header), §11.4.6 (UNVERIFIED on unpinned capabilities, conservative default), §11.4.35 (svc-identity wins on conflict; inherits security invariants), §11.4.104 (participant/identity model alignment), §11.4.65/.153 (HTML+PDF[+DOCX] exports follow in refinement).